Séquence 4

Fashion victims

Sommaire

Objectifs de la séquence

1. Increasing your knowledge of the world of fashion
2. Understanding people talking about a social issue
3. Formulating ideas from notes
4. Developing your listening skills
5. On the road to autonomy

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"Every generation laughs at the old fashions, but religiously follows the new."

Thoreau, American philosopher, 1817-1862

"Fashion is what you adopt, when you don't know who you are."

Quentin Crisp, British author, 1908-1999

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Objectifs de la séquence

Dans cette séquence, vous allez apprendre à rédiger une lettre de protestation et à comprendre des témoignages radiophoniques.

Pour cela, des activités vous seront proposées à partir de documents variés liés à l'industrie de la mode, pour vous informer et développer vos compétences en lecture et en expression orale et écrite.

1. Get ready: increasing your knowledge of the world of fashion

Vous allez faire le point sur ce que vous savez déjà du monde de la mode, et approfondir vos connaissances aussi bien sur le plan culturel que linguistique.

2. Understanding people talking about a social issue

Vous allez vous familiariser avec le rôle joué par l'Inde dans l'industrie du textile, puis vous entraîner à développer des stratégies d'écoute : l'anticipation à partir de la situation de communication, le repérage de mots accentués, leur mise en relation, la synthétisation des informations.

3. Formulating ideas from notes

Vous allez apprendre à passer d'idées représentées sous forme de schéma ou de simples notes à la rédaction de paragraphes cohérents.

4. Developing your listening skills

Vous allez mettre en application les stratégies d'écoute travaillées en amont, toujours en approfondissant vos connaissances culturelles.

5. On the road to autonomy

Vous allez vous entraîner à rédiger une lettre. Vous allez d'abord travailler les expressions utiles avant de mettre en application tout ce que vous avez appris dans cette séquence.

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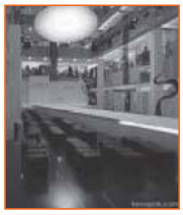
1 Increasing your knowledge of the world of fashion

Activity 1

Here is a series of short quizzes to establish how well you already know the world of fashion:

❶ Label the correct picture with the following words.

mini skirt platform shoes catwalk trilby hat poodle skirt



....

❷ Do the following general knowledge quiz about fashion.

▸ **1.** Which actress was famous for her peroxide blonde hair?

- ❒ a. Jean Harlow
- ❒ b. Audrey Hepburn
- ❒ c. Greta Garbo
- ❒ d. Joan Collins

▸ **2.** What was it very fashionable to do in the 1940's for the troops away from home?

- ❒ a. bake them cakes
- ❒ b. send them eternity rings
- ❒ c. send them celebrities to entertain them
- ❒ d. hand-knit clothes (to knit: *tricoter*)

▸ **3.** In what decade did the poodle skirt become popular?

- ❒ a. the 50's
- ❒ b. the 60's
- ❒ c. the 70's
- ❒ d. the 80's

▸ **4.** What was Coco Chanel's real name?

- ❒ a. Angélique
- ❒ b. Gabrielle
- ❒ c. Carmen
- ❒ d. Amélie

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▶ **5.** Who invented the mini skirt?

- ❒ a. Vivian Westwood
- ❒ b. Mary Quant
- ❒ c. Coco Chanel
- ❒ d. Jean-Paul Gaultier

▶ **6.** Which designer invented the expression “power dressing”?

- ❒ a. Stella Mc Cartney
- ❒ b. Anna Sui
- ❒ c. Donna Karen
- ❒ d. Katherine Hamnet

▶ **7.** What was the symbol of “power dressing” in the 80’s that shows like Dynasty or Dallas exploited to excess?

- ❒ a. mobile phones
- ❒ b. belts
- ❒ c. shoulder pads
- ❒ d. handbags

▶ **8.** What piece of clothing was the T.V. detective, Columbo, famous for wearing?

- ❒ a. a trilby hat
- ❒ b. white trainers
- ❒ c. a brown raincoat
- ❒ d. black socks

▶ **9.** Which super-model is/was married to a famous football player?

- ❒ a. Naomi Campbell
- ❒ b. Kate Moss
- ❒ c. Sophie Dahl
- ❒ d. Claudia Schiffer

▶ **10.** Who is the art director of Louis Vuitton?

- ❒ a. Louis Vuitton
- ❒ b. John Galliano
- ❒ c. Marc Jacobs
- ❒ d. Karl Lagerfeld

❸ Now do this quiz to find out how hip (= fashionable) you are yourself!

▶ **1.** Do you think it is important to be fashionable ?

- ❒ a. absolutely!
- ❒ b. only for clothes you wear every day
- ❒ c. only for special occasions
- ❒ d. not at all!

▶ **2.** How do you know about fashion?

- ❒ a. you read fashion magazines
- ❒ b. you watch fashion shows on TV or on the net.
- ❒ c. you ask your friends
- ❒ d. you don’t!

▶ **3.** How often do you buy new clothes?

- ❒ a. at least once a week
- ❒ b. at least once a month
- ❒ c. at least twice a year
- ❒ d. only when you really need to

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▶ **4.** How often do you get dressed up? (to dress up = to wear something special)

- ❒ a. every day
- ❒ b. once a week
- ❒ c. five or six times a year
- ❒ d. as rarely as possible!

▶ **5.** What do you think of a man who is bald (= he cut off his hair) in the name of fashion?

- ❒ a. you think it's great!
- ❒ b. you approve if other men do it as well
- ❒ c. you disapprove if he only does it to copy someone else!
- ❒ d. you totally disapprove!

▶ **6.** What do you think of a woman who is bald (= she cut off her hair) in the name of fashion?

- ❒ a. you think it's great!
- ❒ b. you approve if other women do it as well
- ❒ c. you disapprove if she only does it to copy someone else!
- ❒ d. you totally disapprove!

▶ **7.** What do you look for when you buy clothes?

- ❒ a. the latest fashion
- ❒ b. something classic that will never be unfashionable
- ❒ c. value for money
- ❒ d. the cheapest price

▶ **8.** Where do you buy your clothes?

- ❒ a. at designer stores
- ❒ b. at ready to wear (*prêt-à-porter*) boutiques
- ❒ c. by catalogue or on the Internet
- ❒ d. at the local supermarket

▶ **9.** How long does it take you to get dressed?

- ❒ a. ages! (= *une éternité*)
- ❒ b. an hour
- ❒ c. half an hour
- ❒ d. 5 minutes

▶ **10.** How often do you change your fashion?

- ❒ a. every time there is a change in fashion
- ❒ b. at least once a year
- ❒ c. every two or three years
- ❒ d. never

Check your answers and read your personal fashion profile.

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Activity 2

You are going to give an oral presentation on your attitude to fashion.

First, let's make sure you are familiar with the vocabulary you can use.

❶ Put the following expressions, from the left column, in the most suitable place in the sentences below.

conservative

fashion conscious

fashion victim

out of fashion

role model

sensible

up to date

fashionable

1. I wear my clothes until they fall apart, unlike many of my friends who give them away when they are .....
2. I really admire teenagers who have piercings in their eyebrows and a ..... hairstyle, but I'm too scared of my parents' reaction.
3. I wouldn't mind being an air hostess except that I find the uniform is too ..... Why don't airline companies change their uniforms with the fashion?
4. Personally, I don't have a particular ..... I copy whoever wears clothes that I find particularly original, even if they come from a second-hand shop!
5. My sister is a real ..... : she buys new clothes every time the fashions change and spends all her birthday money on them.
6. She reads at least one fashion magazine every week to keep ..... .
7. Even when we go on a picnic, she wears her fashion footwear instead of ..... shoes.
8. We often quarrel because she accuses me of not being ..... .

Check your answers.

❷ Prepare your ideas for your oral presentation on your attitude to fashion.

❸ Make your oral presentation. Record yourself as you speak. Then listen to assess your performance.

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Use the box below to help you prepare:

Your attitude to fashion in general:	Structures to express your attitude:	
• Why you like/dislike fashion? • Your favourite fashion/the fashion you hate the most • Your fashion idol/favourite model	love adore be keen on be fond of approve of	hate can't stand can't bear disapprove of
Your attitude to: • hairstyles • shoes • bags • make up • jewelry • tattoes • piercings	be interested in take pleasure in would like to + V wish (I could + V) admire envy	have no interest in take no pleasure in condemn reproach somebody <u>for</u> something

Comment évaluer votre prestation à l'oral ?

Cochez la case qui correspond le mieux à votre prestation.

Votre discours s'enchaîne	❒ plutôt difficilement	❒ plutôt facilement	❒ de manière fluide
Vous faites	❒ beaucoup d'erreurs grammaticales	❒ peu d'erreurs grammaticales	❒ rarement des erreurs grammaticales
Vous utilisez	❒ un vocabulaire assez limité	❒ un vocabulaire plutôt varié	❒ un vocabulaire riche et varié
Vous parlez avec	❒ un accent étranger assez prononcé	❒ un accent étranger peu perceptible	❒ une bonne prononciation
Dans votre exposé vous parlez	❒ de ce que vous aimez, n'aimez pas et vous justifiez votre opinion très simplement	❒ de votre opinion sur le sujet en développant des points importants avec précision	❒ du sujet en développant une argumentation personnelle en mettant en évidence les avantages et inconvénients de votre opinion
	= Niveau A2 niveau attendu pour le Brevet	= Niveau B1 niveau attendu fin 3e/2de	= Niveau B2 niveau visé pour le baccalauréat

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En fonction de votre diagnostic, vous savez ce que vous devez faire. Vous devez travailler sur deux plans :

1. La qualité de la langue

Le vocabulaire et la grammaire s'apprennent, surtout en analysant vos erreurs pour y remédier. L'accent étranger se perd en écoutant et en répétant beaucoup. Pour développer la fluidité (l'enchaînement fluide de votre discours), il faut parler et parler encore !

2. La richesse du contenu

Plus vos idées sont riches et développées, mieux c'est. Au final, on voudrait que vous puissiez faire preuve des mêmes aptitudes rédactionnelles en anglais qu'en français. A ce stade de votre cursus, il ne suffit plus de s'exprimer dans une langue correcte : il faut montrer que vous êtes capable de mener une réflexion approfondie, de prendre position et d'argumenter pour défendre vos idées (tout en montrant une prise en compte des idées d'autrui).

Encore une fois, c'est l'entraînement qui vous permettra de progresser !

Activity 3

The hidden side of fashion

Use the Word Bank to describe and compare the two pictures below. Try to date them and relate them to the world of fashion, asking yourself which picture – if any – represents fashion victims. (You can do this orally, or if you prefer, write down your answer).

Garment workers in sweatshop. © akg-images / North Wind Picture Archives.

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Tesco Bansky Clean Clothes campaign.
© Photo Cate Gillon / Getty Images / AFP.

Wordbank

Noun

garments = clothes/clothing
a sewing workshop
a clothes line
cloth (*tissu*)
workpiece
stool (*tabouret*)
sunlight
heads bowed (*têtes baissées*)
working conditions
hand on chest
colour ≠ black and white
tones of grey
flag (drapeau)
a Tesco shopping bag
a girl with a pony tail
boys in shorts
symbolism
consumer society
mass distribution
irony
artistic representation

Verb

to sew/ səʊ /(*coudre*)
to hang on a line

to salute/pledge allegiance
to honour
to raise the flag
to watch the flag rise up the flagpole

to depict/portray/ show
to symbolise
to represent
to suggest/evoke/convey (an idea of...)

Useful expressions

Contrast

while/whereas S+V+C
unlike/contrary to +C
in contrast,/On the contrary, ...
On the other hand

to praise ≠ to condemn
to criticise = be critical of

Cause

because/since/as +S+V
because of/on account of +C

CD 2
Enr.1

Compare your answer with the model answer in the corrections and on the recording.

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2 Understanding people talking about a social issue

Activity 4

Tuning your ears and checking your general knowledge!

Before tackling an oral document on the textile industry – the social issue we are studying in this sequence – let's make sure you have the necessary background information on India.

1 Listen to your CD and for each piece of information decide whether it is true or false.

	True	False
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		
6.		
7.		
8.		
9.		
10.		

Check your answers and get some extra information.

You may read the model answer or / and listen to it on the CD.

2 Now let's make sure you know as much as you should about one of the most important figures in the recent history of India: Mahatma Gandhi.

Use the notes below to make an oral presentation on Gandhi. (Try to do it without writing anything).

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Mahatma Gandhi

Birth	1869 – Gujarat (state in northern India)
Father	important local politician
Arranged marriage	aged 13 (1st child before 20)
Studies	law – London 1888-1891 (dislikes English food → vegetarian)
1893-1914	South Africa: lawyer – observes racial discrimination – develops idea of non-violence (ahimsa in Hindu religion)
1914	return to India: life of simplicity (little money, few clothes) encourages farmers to resist British domination (taxes) → famous practises non-violent resistance & non-cooperation (boycotts, refusal to pay taxes, prison…)
1918-1947	campaigns for Indian independence (success but → 2 countries: India (Hindu) & Pakistan (Muslim)
1948	assassinated by Hindu radical

= major influence on other leaders of freedom struggles: **M.L. King & N. Mandela**

Record yourself as you speak. Then listen to assess your performance.

Comment évaluer votre prestation à l'oral ?

Cochez la case qui correspond le mieux à votre prestation.

Votre discours s'enchaîne	❒ plutôt difficilement	❒ plutôt facilement	❒ avec aisance
Vous faites	❒ beaucoup d'erreurs grammaticales	❒ peu d'erreurs grammaticales, mais la syntaxe reste simple	❒ peu d'erreurs, malgré une complexité syntaxique
Vous utilisez	❒ un vocabulaire assez limité	❒ un vocabulaire plutôt varié	❒ un vocabulaire riche
Vous parlez avec	❒ un accent étranger assez prononcé	❒ un accent étranger peu perceptible	❒ un accent d'anglophone
	= Niveau A2 niveau attendu pour le Brevet	= Niveau B1 niveau attendu fin 3e/2de	= Niveau B2 niveau visé pour le baccalauréat

En fonction de votre diagnostic, vous savez ce que vous devez faire. Le vocabulaire et la grammaire s'apprennent, surtout en analysant vos erreurs pour y remédier. L'accent étranger se perd en écoutant et en répétant beaucoup. Pour développer la fluidité (l'enchaînement fluide de votre discours), il faut parler et parler encore !

Compare your answer with the model.

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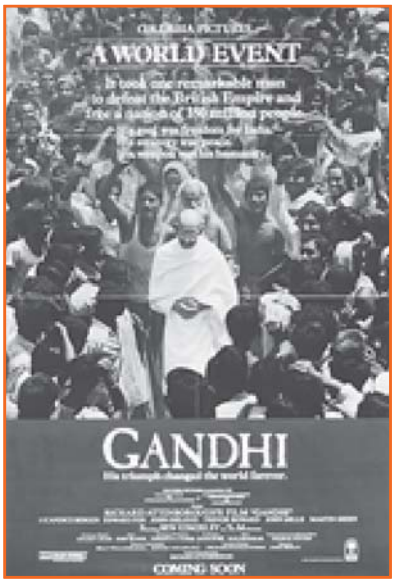
Activity 5

Making sense of a speech by Mahatma Gandhi

❶ **Note down your ideas in connection with each picture and the corresponding prompt.** (What impression does the picture give you?)



▶ **The attitude of the Indian population towards Gandhi:**

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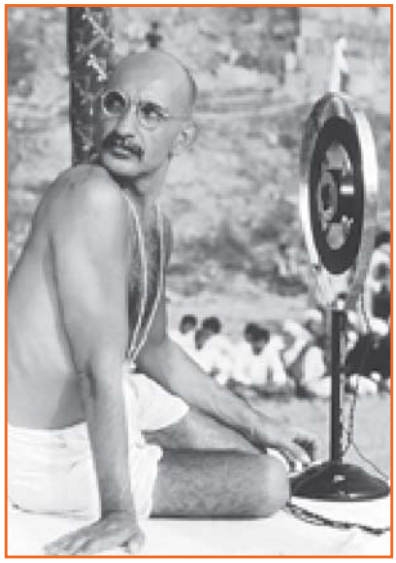
© Indo-British / Int Film Investors / The Kobal Collection / The Picture Desk / AFP.



▶ **The image Gandhi wants to present of himself:**

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© COLUMBIA PICTURES / Album / AKG.

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© akg-images / Archiv Peter Rühe.

▶ **Gandhi's attitude to clothing:**

.....

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© COLUMBIA PICTURES / Album / AKG.

▶ **Gandhi's attitude to the authority represented in this picture:**

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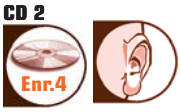
CD 2



❷ **Listen to the extract from Gandhi's speech and try to understand as much as possible.**

Nous vous proposons deux pistes de travail en fonction du degré de facilité de votre écoute. Essayez la première d'abord, et si besoin suivez la deuxième.

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Main steps	Extra help
1. Listen to the recording (several times if necessary) and **a.** note down the key words (= significant words you understand) **b.** place the key words in the corresponding box in the table in Exercise 1 above. **2.** Listen again and concentrate on the parts of the speech that you find difficult. Try to make a connection with the information you already have. Add any new information. **3.** Listen again and pay attention to the pronouns – Who do they refer to? **4.** Sum up orally what you understand so far.	**1.** Listen to pick out names of people and places. **2.** Listen again to find information (words or ideas) about those people or places. **Complete the table.** **3.** Try to connect the information with the pictures above. **4.** Sum up orally what you understand so far.

People / places	Additional information

b. Think carefully about the cultural background to answer the following questions in relation to Gandhi's speech. (You may listen again if necessary.)

1. "*we*" = ❒ the British ❒ the Indians ❒ the South Africans
"*you*" = ❒ the British ❒ the Indians ❒ the South Africans
"*me*" = ...

2. Draw arrows (→) to associate each notion with the appropriate category of people:

the British ●	○ violence ○ ○ firmness ○ ○ poverty ○ ○ dignity ○	● the Indians

3. Manchester and Leeds are ..... (quote the speech!)

Delhi and London are ..... (it's a general knowledge question!)

c. Listen again and pay attention to Gandhi's tone of voice.

1. He is ❒ hesitant ❒ calm ❒ incisive
❒ firm ❒ agitated ❒ indifferent

2. Pick out two ways of using verbs which show that he wants the Indians to do something (*repérer deux formes / structures verbales qui montrent que Gandhi veut que les Indiens agissent*).

.....

.....

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d. Listen again and note down the three different actions Gandhi wants his people to do.

Remember the subject of his speech: ..... (one word).

1. .....

2. .....

3. .....

e. Suggest a meaning for "homespun" (in the last sentence):
..... (in French if necessary).

f. Sum up the essential message of Gandhi's speech in a short paragraph, using the information above.

Check your answers.

Think about:
- **the subject of the speech,**
- **the immediate context: (..., wear it with dignity)**
- **the composition of the word (home + spun)**
- **the photographs you have studied**

Comment s'organiser pour réussir une compréhension orale ?

Il faut procéder par étapes comme vous venez de faire avec le discours de Gandhi.

1. Anticiper sur le contenu (= mobiliser vos idées, et réfléchir aux mots-clés en anglais par rapport au contexte annoncé – par l'introduction, des images, le sujet etc.)

Lors d'écoutes successives :

2. Repérer les mots-clés (personnes, lieux, répétitions, même champ sémantique...)
3. Opérer un classement de ces mots-clés et repérer les informations essentielles pour chacun d'eux.
4. S'il y a des pronoms, repérer à quoi ils renvoient.
5. Rassembler toutes les informations recueillies et essayer de reconstruire le sens du document en prenant en compte la dimension culturelle (et vos connaissances générales).
6. Focaliser sur la tonalité des interlocuteurs et essayer d'identifier leurs intentions.
7. Dans le cas de mots importants inconnus, réfléchir au sens possible par rapport au sujet, au contexte dans lequel les mots sont utilisés, à la construction des mots (composition ou dérivation) et au contexte au sens large (dimension culturelle).
8. Résumer ce que vous avez compris (et ré-écouter si vous avez l'impression qu'il vous manque des éléments essentiels).

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Activity 6

Listen to the document as many times as necessary using the methodology we have studied. Make notes, then organise your ideas to sum up the document (synthesis).

Your notes .....

.....

.....

.....

Your synthesis .....

.....

.....

.....

Inference concerning probable unknown words

Overtime = ...

Shift(s) = ...

Check your answers.

You may read the model answer or / and listen to it on the CD.

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3 Formulating ideas from notes

N'oubliez pas :

1. **l'ordre canonique : Sujet + Verbe + Complément**
2. **l'accord sujet + verbe conjugué**
3. **l'emploi des articles :**
   - **élément défini, spécifique → the ;**
   - **élément indéfini et singulier → a/an**
   - **élément abstrait / non spécifique / général → Ø (on ne met pas d'article)**
4. **l'ajout éventuel de prépositions pour indiquer le lien entre les éléments**
5. **l'ajout éventuel de conjonctions ou de mots de liaison**

Dans cette étape, nous allons voir comment passer d'idées représentées sous forme de schéma ou de simples notes à la rédaction de paragraphes cohérents.

Activity 7

Living conditions for garment workers in emerging countries

Practise making sentences from the key words for each of these pictures from the **Clean Clothes Campaign** *(http://www.clean-clothes.org/resources/photos)* to write about the conditions of garment workers.

© FTZGSEU (Free Trade Zone and General Services Employees' Union)

1. **Garment workers / live / wooden huts / tin roofs / no sanitation.**

   Garment workers live in wooden huts with tin roofs and no sanitation.

- **Everyone / sleep / one bed.**

  .....

  .....

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© Taslima Akhter / Clean Clothes Campaign.

❷ **entire family / composed / 11 people / three generations / share / one room.**

.....

.....

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© Ankur Ahuja / Clean Clothes Campaign.

❸ **a. While / mother / sleep / eldest son / teach / younger brothers.**

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.....

Vocabulary notes

* **school drop out:** someone who stops going to school before taking his exams.

b. He / be / school drop-out* / unemployed leather worker.

.....

.....

© Taslima Akhter / Clean Clothes Campaign.

❹ **After / hard day's work / several families / share / same space / wash clothes / cook evening meal / bathe.**

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NOBODY IS ALLOWED TO GET WATER
DURING WORK TIME

Bawal manguha ng tubig sa orab
Ng trabaho

MANAGEMENT

5 a. drink water / forbidden / working hours.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

b. most workers / afraid / join a union / labor rights abuses / frequent.

.....

.....

Activity 8

Let's study the process of selling sportswear in greater detail.

	Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4
Action	produce / manufacture	transport / ship	display / sell	buy / purchase
People	factory workers	(buyers for) global sportswear company	retail* manager	customer
Places	emerging country	industrialised country	retail outlet: sportswear shop	sports shop / sportswear store

Study the sentence about the first step in the process.

* retail = *détail*

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❶ **Sportswear is manufactured in emerging countries.**

a. Identify the subject: .....

b. Identify the verb and analyse its form: .....

c. Compare the sentence with the elements in the table. Which element is absent? .....

Proceed in the same manner from Step 2 to Step 4.

❷ .....

❸ .....

❹ .....

Comment décrire un processus ?

Quelle forme verbale utilise-t-on pour décrire un processus ? .....

Quel est le sujet de la phrase lorsque l'on décrit un processus :

- ❒ l'agent qui réalise l'action
- ❒ l'objet qui subit l'action
- ❒ l'entité qui finance l'action

Check your answers

Activity 9

Writing a letter

Study the Fact file on the following page. Read the description of the task, then do the activities that follow to help you prepare the task.

Your task Write a letter to defend a campaign.

The situation You have been elected President of your local Students Against Sweatshops Organisation and you want to convince the president of your university to support a campaign against university sportswear manufactured in sweatshops in emerging countries (= Sweat-free campus campaign). You are going to write him a letter to defend your campaign.

The facts The information you have already studied in this sequence + the flyer on the following page.

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FACT FILE

Sweatshops

Definition: a sweatshop is a place of work with an employer who does not respect any law governing minimum wage and overtime, child labour, industrial homework, occupational safety and health, worker's compensation, or industry regulation.

Origin: to sweat = to transpire from hard physical effort or fear

Example 1: a 10,000 worker factory, hidden behind concrete walls that are topped by coiled barbed wire and broken glass and patrolled by guards armed with shotguns.

Example 2: a dozen workers in the basement of an ordinary apartment building in a downtown garment district.

Victims: young women, migrants from the countryside or immigrants from other countries.

Conditions of employment: They work long hours for wages that are not enough to feed, clothe, and shelter their families. Managers deny them visits to the toilet and sick leave to maintain high production quotas. They make workers do pregnancy tests and use birth control to avoid having to pay for maternity leave. Verbal and physical abuse is common. Workers' safety and health are neglected. If workers organize to improve their conditions, they are fired and blacklisted for other employment.

1 Vocabulary help

Match each word from the table in the flyer (prospectus, tract) with its French equivalent:

wage ○	○ bénéfices pour le fabricant
fabric ○	○ coût de la main d'œuvre
overhead ○	○ frais de fonctionnement
labor ○	○ frais de transport
factory profit ○	○ marge à la vente
shipping ○	○ paie
retail markup ○	○ tissu

2 Organise your ideas

Put the following steps in the most coherent order.

N°	Points to develop in your letter
	Ask permission to promote a sweat-free campus campaign in your university
	Present your organization
	Explain the problem of sweatshops
	Present the idea of a sweat-free campus campaign
	Present yourself

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What's the difference between creating poverty and fighting it? 25 cents.

POVERTY WAGES:	
Fabric	$2.00
Overhead	$1.00
Labor	**$0.25**
Factory Profit	$0.75
Shipping	$0.75
Retail markup	$15.25
YOUR PRICE:	**$20.00**

LIVING WAGES:	
Fabric	$2.00
Overhead	$1.00
Labor	**$0.50**
Factory Profit	$0.75
Shipping	$0.75
Retail markup	*$15.00**
YOUR PRICE:	**$20.00**

The cost of a living wage is...

...about 25¢ on your $20 shirt. For less than 1% of Nike's advertising budget, wages could be doubled for all workers making Nike university clothing. That may not be much for the brands, but for a worker, that's the difference between eating breakfast or working for ten hours on an empty stomach. **If the brand absorbs the 25¢ cost, the price doesn't change!*

Tell the brands who make our clothes: Living Wages NOW!

Support the NEW Sweat-Free Campus Campaign

www.studentsagainstsweatshops.org ★ 202.NO.SWEAT

D.R.

3 a. Complete the following letter

(Follow the instructions for each paragraph.)

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Brian Templeton
President of Students Against Sweatshops Organisation,
Cornell University

Mr Parkinson,
President of Cornell University,
Cornell House,
Cornell

20th September 201.....,

Object: Sweat-free campus campaign

Put the verbs into the correct tense. Write out in a complete sentence.

Dear Sir,

I ..... (write) to you as I ..... (just / elect) President of the Students Against Sweatshops Organisation.

The aim / this organization = fight against / exploitation / garment workers

.....

/ sweatshops / America / emerging countries.

.....

Develop these points: working hours, low pay, fatigue, abuse. Connect ideas with link words.

Indeed, conditions in sweatshops are deplorable. Workers .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Complete with a/an / the / Ø.

Our organisation has calculated that ..... reduction of 25 cents in ..... retail markup of ..... item of ..... university sportswear would result in ..... 100% increase in ..... garment worker's wages. ..... sweat-free campus campaign would guarantee that all sportswear sold on ..... campus contributes to ..... better wage for all garment workers.

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Begin with an appropriate link word and finish the sentence.

..... I would like you / authorise / organisation /

.....

conduct / sweat-free campus campaign / Cornell.

.....

Looking forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,

Brian Templeton

b. Study the letter and label the different parts (in the boxes in the left-hand column):

signature	date	addressee's address
object	sender's address	

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4 Developing your listening skills

Activity 10

You are going to hear an interview between a member of FairWear and an Australian outworker.

Read the Fact file, then do the activities below.

FACT FILE

FAIRWEAR

Definition: FairWear is an Australian organisation

Aims*: eliminate the gross exploitation of homeworkers (outworkers) in the Australian clothing industry

Means*: encourage Australians to think critically about where the clothes they wear are produced and under what conditions

Homeworkers = women who make clothes in their homes in the suburbs of Australia

Working conditions:

- Wages: $3 to $4 an hour
- Hours: up to 18 hours a day, 7 days a week
- Employers: major retailers, designers and even suppliers of school uniforms

Consequence: homeworkers = the lowest paid and most exploited Australian workers

Numbers: 300 000 people including the family members (1995 figures)

* aim = objective; means: *moyens*

1 Imagine the questions a FairWear reporter could ask an Australian outworker. (Write them – in note form - in the left-hand column.)

Interviewer's questions	Outworker's answers

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(continued) Interviewer's questions	Outworker's answers

❷ Listen to the recording (as many times as necessary), and check if your questions are asked.

a. Note down the outworker's corresponding answers in the right-hand column above.

b. Note down any questions you didn't anticipate and the corresponding answers too.

❸ Listen again and note down any additional information about the outworker that you consider important.

Check your answers.

Practice makes perfect

Ce n'est pas l'objectif principal de cette séquence, mais nous vous invitons à profiter de cette occasion pour travailler votre anglais parlé. Regardez le script de cet extrait dans le corrigé, réfléchissez à la nature des phrases et à l'intonation qui s'impose. Puis entraînez-vous à jouer les rôles. Enregistrez-vous et comparez votre prestation avec l'original.

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5 On the road to autonomy

Prenez connaissance de la tâche suivante avant de réaliser les activités 11 et 12. (N'oubliez pas que le but de cette partie de la séquence est de vous permettre de consolider vos acquis).

Your task Write a letter to the president of your favourite retailer (the clothes label that you buy most frequently).

The situation After all you have learnt about sweatshops and outworkers, you have become an ethical consumer. You want to be sure your favorite retailer is an ethical employer. You expect this retailer to honour the living wage for its gament workers and to guarantee its position by signing the Ethical Trade Code of Conduct*. (You will need to explain why you are defending the garment workers.) You are going to write him a letter to explain your position.

* Ethical Trade Code of Conduct: Code de Bonne Conduite du Commerce Éthique.

Some more facts:

FACT FILE

The living wage

Definition: A wage that enables workers to meet their needs for:
- nutritious food;
- clean water;
- shelter;
- clothes;
- education;
- health care;
- transport;
- a discretionary income *(revenu disponible)*.

A wage that covers:
- the basic needs of workers and their families;
- the cost of living;
- social security benefits.

A wage that is based on a standard working week:
- before overtime;
- after any deductions [for example social security payments].

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Explicitation de la tâche

Vous devez rédiger une lettre (en anglais) au président de votre marque de vêtements préférée afin de le convaincre de l'importance du commerce éthique. Vous souhaitez qu'il s'engage à honorer le salaire (minimum) vital, et qu'il garantisse la position de son entreprise en signant le Code de Bonne Conduite du Commerce Ethique. (Il faudra expliquer les raisons pour lesquelles vous cherchez à défendre les ouvriers de l'habillement). (Vous avez toute latitude pour intégrer d'autres idées ou arguments pour le convaincre).

Activity 11

Preparation work

Study the Vocabulary help box below carefully, then do the exercises that follow.

Vocabulary help box

Pour exprimer la volonté :
would like (C) to + V
expect (C) to + V
hope (that...)
wish S would + V

Pour exprimer la persuasion :
to persuade C to + V
to convince C to + V

Pour exprimer la cause :
because / since / as } + S + V
because of / on account of / owing to } + C

Pour exprimer la consequence :
to cause
to lead to
to bring about
as a consequence/result...
consequently...
that's why + S + V

Pour exprimer la contrainte :
to make C + V
to oblige C to + V

Pour exprimer l'autorisation :
to let C+ V
to allow C to + V

1 Reformulate the following sentences using the verb between brackets (...). Pay attention to the structure each time.

a. I would like your company to adopt an ethical attitude. → I (expect)...

b. Very often, factory managers don't allow garment workers to go to the toilet. → (let)

c. They also oblige their workers to do overtime. → (make)

d. More humane working conditions will lead to higher productivity. → (bring about)

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2 Replace the underlined word or expression in each sentence with a suitable alternative, changing the structure if necessary.

a. As they work such long hours, the workers often fall asleep during their lunch break.

b. Garment workers are often defenceless because of the absence of trade unions which are not tolerated in Chinese factories.

c. Customers expect companies to take care of their employees in a humane way.

d. Multinationals should not let their subcontractors exploit workers.

e. The consumer of the 21st century wants to oblige companies to guarantee basic human rights to all their employees.

f. A petition will probably convince them to act.

g. The public is more and more aware of the gap between the industrialised world and the Third World. That's why clothes chains are starting to react.

Check your answers.

Activity 12

Complete the task (the letter to the president of your favourite clothes label), following the steps below:

1 Follow the steps in Activity 9 to prepare your letter.

2 Write your letter out, respecting the formal presentation and presenting it in paragraphs.

3 Read it through carefully to edit any mistakes.

Compare your final version with the model letter. ■

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